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NON-TRANSITORY COMPUTER READABLE MEDIUM STORING PROGRAM, AND GAMING DEVICE

Abstract

There is provided a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing a computer to function as: an execution unit configured to execute a fighting game using a game element; a play field presentation unit configured to present a play field including a plurality of areas; and a game element presentation unit configured to present character information of a game element of a player positioned in a first area among the plurality of areas so that the character information is visually unrecognizable to an opponent player, and to present character information of a game element of the player positioned in a second area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the opponent player.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application claims priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2024-036361 filed in the Japan Patent Office on Mar. 8, 2024, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

[0002] The present invention relates to a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program, and a gaming device.

2. Description of the Related Art

[0003] In recent years, game systems have been widespread which provide games to the terminals of players through a communication network. The server of the game systems provides various game elements usable for games (for example, Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication No. 2015-047516).

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0004] In the game system as described above, it is an important task to devise the types of game elements provided to players and the method for presenting the game elements to continue the interest of the players to the games. As a result, games with improved enjoyment for players are provided.

[0005] Thus, it is an object of the present invention to provide a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program and a gaming device that can provide games with improved enjoyment for players.

[0006] An aspect of the present invention provides a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing a computer to function as: an execution unit configured to execute a fighting game using a game element; a play field presentation unit configured to present a play field including a plurality of areas; and a game element presentation unit configured to present character information of a game element of a player positioned in a first area among the plurality of areas so that the character information is visually unrecognizable to an opponent player, and to present character information of a game element of the player positioned in a second area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the opponent player.

[0007] An aspect of the present invention provides a gaming device including: an execution unit configured to execute a fighting game using a game element; a play field presentation unit configured to present a play field including a plurality of areas; and a game element presentation unit configured to present character information of a game element of a player positioned in a first area among the plurality of areas so that the character information is visually unrecognizable to an opponent player, and to present character information of a game element of the player positioned in a second area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the opponent player.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0008] FIG. **1** is a view illustrating an entire configuration example of a game system in the present embodiment;

[0009] FIG. **2** is a view illustrating a device configuration example of a laptop PC which is an example of a player terminal;

[0010] FIG. **3** is a view for explaining an example of the front surface of a leader card;

[0011] FIG. **4** is a view for explaining an example of the back surface of the leader card;

[0012] FIG. **5** is a view for explaining an example of the front surface of a battle card;

[0013] FIG. **6** is a view for explaining an example of the back surface of the battle card;

[0014] FIG. **7** is a view for explaining an example of the front surface of an extra card;

[0015] FIG. **8** is a block diagram illustrating a functional configuration example of the player terminal;

[0016] FIG. **9** is a table illustrating an example of a player information database;

[0017] FIG. **10** is a table illustrating an example of a game element information database;

[0018] FIG. **11** is a view illustrating an example of a home screen;

[0019] FIG. **12** is a view illustrating an example of a store screen;

[0020] FIG. **13** is a view illustrating an example of a store screen;

[0021] FIG. **14** is a view illustrating an example of display of currently tradable game elements and currently untradable game elements on the store screen;

[0022] FIG. **15** is a view illustrating an example of display of breakdown between paid-for and free of charge in-game currency units currently possessed;

[0023] FIG. **16** is a view illustrating an example of an in-game currency providing screen;

[0024] FIG. **17** is a view illustrating an example of when the number of times of provision (grant) of a first paid-for currency pack has reached an upper limit, resulting in a sold-out state;

[0025] FIG. **18** is a view illustrating an example of a screen to be displayed when the in-game currency for the price of a game element is insufficient

[0026] FIG. **19** is a block diagram illustrating a functional configuration example of a game server;

[0027] FIG. **20** is a table illustrating an example of a user information management database;

[0028] FIG. **21** is a table illustrating an example of a game element management database;

[0029] FIG. **22** is a table illustrating an example of a store management database;

[0030] FIG. **23** is a sequence diagram for explaining the operation of the player terminal and the game server;

[0031] FIG. **24** shows tables for explaining determination as to whether each game element is providable (grantable) or unprovidable (ungrantable);

[0032] FIG. **25** is a view illustrating an example of a notification made when the total charge exceeds a predetermined amount;

[0033] FIG. **26** shows views for explaining modification of the embodiment;

[0034] FIGS. **27**A to **27**F show views for explaining an opening direction example;

[0035] FIG. **28** is a table illustrating an example of a pack information database;

[0036] FIG. **29** is a sequence diagram for explaining the operation of the player terminal and the game server;

[0037] FIG. **30** is an operation flowchart for a pack opening direction process;

[0038] FIGS. **31**A to **31**F show views for explaining an opening direction example;

[0039] FIGS. **32**A to **32**D show views for explaining an opening direction example;

[0040] FIG. **33** is a view illustrating an example of a deck formation screen;

[0041] FIG. **34** is a view for explaining a first area and a second area;

[0042] FIG. **35** is a view for explaining a function of enlarging game cards in the second area;

[0043] FIG. **36** is an example of popup display when a formed deck satisfies (6) deck non-conforming criterion;

[0044] FIG. **37** is a view illustrating an example of display when a formed deck satisfies a deck non-conforming condition;
[0045] FIG. **38** is an example of a deck information database D**20**;
[0046] FIG. **39** is an example of a registration deck list screen;
[0047] FIG. **40** is a view illustrating an example of a play field presented by a play field presentation unit;
[0048] FIG. **41** is a view illustrating an example of presentation of game cards by a game card presentation unit;
[0049] FIG. **42** is an example of a viewing screen presented on a play field;
[0050] FIG. **43** shows views for explaining the viewing screen;
[0051] FIG. **44** is a view for explaining the viewing screen;
[0052] FIG. **45** shows views for explaining the viewing screen;
[0053] FIG. **46** is a view illustrating an example when a hand of cards is enlarged;
[0054] FIG. **47** shows views for explaining switching between reduced display and enlarged display;
[0055] FIG. **48** is a view for explaining a state of selection of game cards;
[0056] FIG. **49** is a view for explaining a state of selection of game cards; and
[0057] FIG. **50** is a view illustrating an example of display of selectable actions.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

Entire Configuration

[0058] FIG. **1** is a view illustrating an entire configuration example of a game system in the present embodiment. As illustrated in FIG. **1**, the game system includes a player terminal **1**, and a game server **2** which are prepared for players A, B of a game. The player terminal **1** and the game server **2** are connectable to a communication line N, and can communicate with each other.
[0059] The communication line N indicates a communications path that enables data communication. For example, in addition to a dedicated line (dedicated cable) for direct connection and LAN based on the Ethernet (registered trademark), the communication line N includes a communication network such as a telecommunication network, a cable network, and the Internet, and the communication method may be wired or wireless.
[0060] The player terminal **1** is a computer that can execute a game program, and can perform data communication with the game server **2** by connecting to the communication line N through a wireless communication base station. The player terminal **1** is e.g., a personal computer, a smartphone, a mobile phone, a mobile gaming device, a stationary game console, a commercial game console, a tablet computer, and a controller for a stationary game console. Basically, multiple player terminals **1** are provided, and are operated by respective players.
[0061] The game server **2** is a server system that includes a single or multiple server devices and storage devices. The game server **2** provides various services for administering the games of the present embodiment, and is capable of managing data necessary for the administration of the games, and of distributing game programs and data necessary for execution of the games at the player terminals **1**.
[0062] FIG. **2** is a view illustrating a device configuration example of a laptop PC which is an example of the player terminal **1**. As illustrated in FIG. **2**, the player terminal **1** includes a display **11**, and a keyboard **12** which is an operation unit. The player terminal **1** is provided with a control board, a built-in battery, a power button, a sound volume adjustment button, a speaker, and the like which are not illustrated.
[0063] The control board is equipped with various microprocessors, ASIC such as a CPU, a GPU, and a DSP; various IC memories such as a VRAM, a RAM, and a ROM; and a wireless communication module to wirelessly communicate with a mobile phone base station. In addition, the control board is equipped with so-called an I/F circuit (interface circuit) such as a driver circuit of a touch operation panel **12**. The elements mounted on the control board are electrically coupled

to each other through a bus circuit so that reading and writing of data and transmission and reception of signals are made possible.

[0064] Multiple types of game elements appear in the game in the present embodiment. Each game element will be described below.

First Type Game Element

[0065] A first type game element is an article into which a character is transformed, and is represented as an image. The image includes a still image and a video. The article may be an intangible object or a tangible object. The article is e.g., a virtual game card displayed on a computer, or a tangible game card. Note that the article is not limited to the card as long as the article is configured to identify the game element associated with the article. The article may be a modeled object such as a figure having the appearance of a game element. In the following, a case will be described as an example where the first type game element is a virtual game card into which a character is transformed.

[0066] In the game in the present embodiment, game card as the first type game element has multiple types. The information written on the front surface of a game card varies with the type of the game card. Although any number of types of game card may be provided, in the following, a description will be given using an example of three types of game cards: a leader card **21** (a first type first game element), a battle card **22** (a first type second game element), and an extra card **23** (a first type third game element). The common point among all types of game cards is that a character image in a work is associated with each game card. The character image is the image of a character that appears in a work, and in the present embodiment, the image of a scene including the character that appears in a work is also described as a character image. Multiple game cards with the same character and different picture patterns are provided, and treated as different game cards.

[0067] A player constructs a deck in advance using obtained game cards, and plays a game. When a deck is constructed, the total number of cards in the deck and the number of various types of cards are predetermined. In the present embodiment, a description will be given using an example of a deck with the total number of 50 cards including one leader card **21**; however, the deck may have any number of cards as long as the number of cards is predetermined.

[0068] Each game card has a regular position, in which the content written on the game card as seen from a player can be determined as it is. Multiple position states of the game card are provided. In the following description, a state in which the game card is in regular position is called an active state, and a sideways state in which the game card is rotated 90 degrees is called a rest state. In a predetermined area, a reverse position state in which the game card is rotated 180 degrees is called an active state. Note that game card in a predetermined direction may be determined as an active state in advance, and a state when the direction of the game card is changed from the predetermined direction may be determined as a rest state. During a game, these states of the game card may be used as appropriate.

Leader Card **21**

[0069] The leader card **21** (the first type first game element) will be described. FIGS. **3** and **4** are views illustrating an example of the leader card **21**. FIG. **3** is a view for explaining an example of the front surface of the leader card **21**. FIG. **4** is a view for explaining an example of the back surface of the leader card **21**. One leader card **21** is included in each deck. The leader card **21** battles against the leader card **21** or the battle card **22** of the opponent player.

[0070] Character information **10** and card information **11** are respectively written on the front surface and the back surface of the leader card **21**. When a game starts, the leader card **21** is placed so that the front surface is seen; however, when a predetermined condition is satisfied, the leader card **21** is placed so that the back surface is seen.

[0071] The leader card **21** includes the character information **10** and the card information **11**, and the character information **10** includes a character name **101**, a character image **102**, capability information **103**, and effect information **104**.

[0072] The character name **101** is the name of a character associated with the card. In the example illustrated in FIGS. **3** and **4**, “Sakurakouji” is written.
[0073] The character image **102** is the image of a character associated with the card.
[0074] The capability information **103** is a parameter for the ability of a character associated with the game card. In the present embodiment, a description will be given using a case where the power value of a character is written as the capability information. Victory is achieved when the power value is greater than the power value of the battle card **22** of the opponent player. In the example of FIG. **3**, the power value “15000” is written, and in the example of FIG. **4**, the power value “20000” is written.
[0075] The effect information **104** describes skill information related to the effect exercised at the time of attack and awakening information related to the condition and effect for turning the card front to back. In the example of FIG. **3**, “At the time of attack: draw one card.” is written as the skill information, and “When the life is four or less, draw one card. Subsequently, flip the card.” is written as the awakening information.
[0076] Note that the capability information **103** and the effect information **104** may be included in the character information **10**; however, a description will be given using an example in which the capability information **103** and the effect information **104** are not included in the character information.
[0077] The card information **11** includes front/back information **111**, a card type name **112**, a card type symbol **113**, color information **114**, a rarity level **115**, and card identification information **116**.
[0078] The front/back information **111** is information that clearly specifies the front or back of the leader card **21**, and may be any of a character string, illustration, or a symbol mark as long as the information identifies the front or back. In the example illustrated in FIG. **3**, the character “front” indicates the front surface as the front/back information, and in the example illustrated in FIG. **4**, the character string “back” indicates the back surface as the front/back information. Note that the front/back information may be provided at least on the back surface. This is because for the game cards of a card game, the appearance of each card itself is regarded as important, thus extra information should not be written on the front surface.
[0079] The card type name **112** is information indicating the type of a card. The card type name **112** is recorded with information on one of the leader card, the battle card, and the extra card, and in the example of the leader card **21** illustrated FIGS. **3** and **4**, the card type name **112** is recorded with “leader”.
[0080] The card type symbol **113** is recorded with one of the symbols that distinguish between the leader card **21**, the battle card **22**, and the extra card **23**. The leader card **21** is recorded with a leader symbol indicating the leader card. The leader symbol (the first symbol) may be a symbol that can recall the role of the leader card **21** so as to visually identify the leader card.
[0081] The color information **114** indicates information on the color of the card. A player refers to the color information **114** of the leader card **21**, and constructs a deck using the battle cards **22** and the extra cards **23** with the same color information.
[0082] The rarity level **115** indicates the rarity level of the game card. Any display method may be adopted as long as the rarity level is set in advance. In the present embodiment, a description will be given using a case where the rarity is divided into five scales. The example illustrated in FIGS. **3** and **4** exemplifies a case where the rarity level is one.
[0083] The card identification information **116** is recorded with identification information that uniquely identifies the game card. In the example of FIGS. **3** and 4, “001” is written as the card identification information **116**.
[0084] The leader card **21** is different from the other game cards, and the card type symbol **113** (the leader symbol), and the capability information **103** or the effect information **104** are written on the front and back of the card. The capability information **103** or the effect information **104** are different between the front and the back. Thus, evolution or awakening of one character can be

expressed by one card, and it is possible to identify the leader card by the display on the front and back.

Battle Card **22**

[0085] The battle card **22** (the first type second game element) will be described. FIG. **5** is a view for explaining an example of the front surface of the battle card **22**. FIG. **6** is a view for explaining an example of the back surface of the battle card **22**. As illustrated in FIG. **5**, in the battle card **22**, the image of an associated character is shown only on the front surface. All the back surfaces of the battle cards **22** are the same. The battle card **22** is a card for attacking the leader card **21** or the battle card **22** of an opponent player.

[0086] The battle card **22** includes the character information **10** and the card information **11**.

[0087] As in the leader card **21**, the character information **10** includes the character name **101**, the character image **102**, the capability information **103**, and the effect information **104**. In addition, the character information **10** includes combo information **105** and cost information **106**.

[0088] As in the leader card **21**, the character name **101** is the name of a character associated with the card. In the example illustrated in FIG. **5**, "Umekouji" is written.

[0089] As in the leader card **21**, the character image **102** is the image of a character associated with the card.

[0090] As in the leader card **21**, the capability information **103** is a parameter for the ability of a character associated with the card. In the example of FIG. **5**, the power value "20000" is written.

[0091] The effect information **104** is recorded with skill information related to the effect exercised at the time of attack. In the example of FIG. **5**, as the skill information, "When you are attacked and defeated with this card, the life is decreased by one" is written.

[0092] The combo information **105** is information related to power value for increasing the power value of other game cards positioned in the battle area. In the example illustrated in FIG. **5**, "+5000" is written as the combo information **105**.

[0093] The cost information **106** is information on the cost necessary for placing the battle card **22** from the hand of cards to the battle area. For example, the battle card **22** can be placed on the battle area by changing game cards positioned in an energy area, for example, from the active state to the rest state for the number of cards equivalent to the numerical value written in the cost information **106**. In the example of FIG. **5**, "3" is written as the cost information **106**. Note that in the following, changing game cards positioned in an energy area from the active state to the rest state will be described as "paying the cost".

[0094] The card information **11** includes the card type name **112**, the card type symbol **113**, the color information **114**, the rarity level **115**, and the card identification information **116**.

[0095] The card type name **112** is information indicating the type of a card. In the example of the battle card **22** illustrated in FIG. **5**, the card type name **112** is recorded with "Battle".

[0096] The card type symbol **113** is recorded with a battle symbol (a second symbol) that indicates the battle card **22**. The battle symbol may be a symbol that can recall the role of the battle card **22** so as to visually identify the battle card.

[0097] The color information **114** indicates information on the color of the card. A player refers to the color information **114** of the leader card **21**, and constructs a deck using the battle cards **22** and the extra cards **23** with the same color information.

[0098] The rarity level **115** indicates the rarity level of the game card. The example illustrated in FIG. **5** exemplifies a case where the rarity level is one.

[0099] The card identification information **116** is recorded with identification information that uniquely identifies the game card. In the example of FIG. **5**, "002" is written as the card identification information **116**.

Extra Card **23**

[0100] The extra card **23** (the first type third game element) will be described. FIG. **7** is a view for explaining an example of the front surface of the extra card **23**. As illustrated in FIG. **7**, the image of an associated character is shown on the front surface of the extra card **23**. The back surface of the extra card **23** is the same as that of the battle card **22**. Therefore, the back surface of the extra card **23** is the same as that of the battle card **22** illustrated in FIG. **6**.

[0101] The extra card **23** includes the character information **10** and the card information **11**.

[0102] The character information **10** includes the character name **101**, the character image **102**, the effect information **104**, and the cost information **106**.

[0103] The character name **101** is the name of a character associated with the card. In the case of the extra card **23**, the character name **101** is the name of a characteristic scene, a visual scene, a landscape, a background, a building, possession of the character, and an event that appear in a work. In the example of FIG. **7**, "Suimengiri" is written.

[0104] The character image **102** is the image of a character associated with the card, and in the image, a characteristic scene, a visual scene, a landscape, a background, a building, possession of the character, or an event that appear in a work is expressed along with the character.

[0105] The effect information **104** is recorded with skill information related to the effect exercised at the time of attack. In the example of FIG. **7**, as the skill information, "The power value is doubled during one turn" is written.

[0106] The cost information **106** is information on the cost necessary for placing the extra card **23** from the hand of cards to the battle area. In the example of FIG. **7**, "3" is written as the cost information **106**.

[0107] The card information **11** includes the card type name **112**, the card type symbol **113**, the color information **114**, the rarity level **115**, and the card identification information **116**.

[0108] The card type name **112** is information indicating the type of a card. In the example of the extra card **23** illustrated in FIG. **7**, the card type name **112** is recorded with "Extra".

[0109] The card type symbol **113** is recorded with an extra symbol (a third symbol) that indicates the extra card **23**. The extra symbol may be a symbol that can recall the role of the extra card **23** so as to visually identify the extra card.

[0110] The color information **114** indicates information on the color of the card. A player refers to the color information **114** of the leader card **21**, and constructs a deck using the battle cards **22** and the extra cards **23** with the same color information.

[0111] The rarity level **115** indicates the rarity level of the game card. The example illustrated in FIG. **7** exemplifies a case where the rarity level is one.

[0112] The card identification information **116** is recorded with identification information that uniquely identifies the game card. In the example of FIG. **7**, "003" is written as the card identification information **116**.

Second Type Game Element

[0113] The second type game element will be described.

[0114] The second type game element in the present embodiment is a game element used for trading in a game, and is called an in-game currency. The second type game element includes a paid-for second type game element (second type first game element) which can be obtained by a player paying a price (e.g., money), and a free of charge second type game element (second type second game element) which is granted from a game-administration side by achieving a predetermined condition (e.g., a mission prepared by a game-administration side) without exchanging with a price (e.g., money) by a player. The paid-for second type game element (the second type first game element), and the free of charge second type game element (the second type second game element) are primarily used for exchange (purchase) with the above-mentioned first type game element (game card). In the following description, the paid-for second type game element (the second type first game element) is described as the paid-for currency, and the free of charge second type game element (the second type second game element) is described as the free of charge currency.

[0115] Next, the configuration of each device will be described.

Configuration of Player Terminal **1**

[0116] FIG. **8** is a block diagram illustrating a functional configuration example of the player terminal **1**.

[0117] As illustrated in FIG. **8**, the terminal **1** includes a displayer **51**, a game element reader **52**, an operation input **53**, a sound output **54**, a communicator **55**, a storage **56**, and a processor **57**.

[0118] The displayer **51** displays various game screens based on an input image signal. The function of the displayer **51** can be implemented by a display device such as a flat panel display like a liquid crystal, a cathode-ray tube (CRT), a projector, or a head mounted display. In the example of a personal computer of FIG. **2**, the displayer **51** corresponds to the display **11**.

[0119] The game element reader **52** is a reader that reads character information from a game card which is a real article, the character information appearing in a game. The game element reader **52** can read identification information and the like of a game card possessed by a player by setting (arranging) the character that appears in a fighting game to the game element reader **52** using the game card.

[0120] The operation input **53** is for a player to input various operations related to a game, and an operation input signal according to an operation input is output to the processor **57**. The function of the operation input **53** can be implemented not only by a device directly operated by a player's fingers, such as a keyboard, a mouse, a touch operation pad, a home button, a button switch, a joystick, or a track ball, but also by a device that detects motion and posture, such as an acceleration sensor, an angular velocity sensor, an inclination sensor, or a geomagnetic sensor. In the example of the personal computer in FIG. **2**, the operation input **53** corresponds to a keyboard **12**.

[0121] The sound output **54** is for outputting sound effects related to a game based on an input sound signal.

[0122] The communicator **55** implements communication by connecting to the communication line N. The function of the communicator **55** can be implemented by e.g., a wireless communication device, a modem, a terminal adaptor (TA), the jack of a wired communication cable, or a control circuit.

[0123] The storage **56** pre-stores a program, and data or the like used during execution of the program, or temporarily stores the data for each process, the program causing the player terminal **1** to operate, and implementing various functions of the player terminal **1**. The storage **56** can be implemented by e.g., a solid state drive using an IC memory such as a RAM, a ROM, or a flash memory, a magnetic disk such as a hard disk, or an optical disk such as a CD-ROM and a DVD.

[0124] The storage **56** stores a system program and a game program. The system program implements the basic functions of the player terminal **1** as a computer. The game program causes the processor **57** to exert the later-described functions. When a player completes account registration, the program is distributed from the game server **2** or another application distribution server. The storage **56** also stores a database necessary to execute a game. In the present embodiment, the storage **56** stores a player information database D**1**, and a game element information database D**2**.

[0125] The player information database D**1** is a database that stores various types of information on players. FIG. **9** is a table illustrating an example of the player information database D**1**. The player information database D**1** includes a field for player ID, a field for player name, a field for player information, a field for level, a field for profile card information, a field for possessed game card information, a field for deck information, a field for possessed currency information, a field for purchase history information, and a field for last updated date. These pieces of information are associated with each other, and stored.

[0126] The field for player ID is for recording identification information to identify a player. The field for player name is for recording e.g., a nickname. The field for player information is for recording experience points or the like obtained through play of a fighting game. The field for level is for recording the level of a player achieved by accumulation of experience points. The field for profile card information is for recording information on the later-described profile card. The field for possessed game card information is for recording the game card identification information (game card ID) of a game card possessed by a player. The field for deck information is for recording information on a deck constructed from game cards by a player, that is, for recording the game card IDs of the game cards included in the deck.

[0127] The field for possessed currency information is for recording information on the in-game currency possessed by a player, specifically, the amount of each of paid-for currency and free of charge currency. Specifically, for each of paid-for and free of charge types, the date of acquisition of the currency, the acquired currency units, and the total amount are written. The field for purchase history information is for recording the history of purchase of the game cards, and in-game currency purchased by a player. Specifically, the game element ID of a purchased game element, the name of the game element, the purchase date, and the number of purchased game elements are written. The field for last updated date is for recording the last updated date of the player information database D**1**.

[0128] The game element information database D**2** is a database to store information on the game element that appears or is used in a game. FIG. **10** is a table illustrating an example of the game element information database D**2**. The game element information database D**2** includes a field for game element ID, a field for character information, a field for game element image, and a field for last updated date. These pieces of information are associated with each other, and stored. The field for game element ID is for recording identification information (game card ID) to identify the game element such as a game card. The field for character information is for recording the character information (for example, the type of game element, the profile information, the ability value, and the rarity information) of a character which has transformed into a game element. The field for game element image is for recording the image data of a game element itself (e.g., a game card) or the image data of a character which has transformed into a game element. Note that the image data includes a still image and a video. The field for last updated date is for recording the last updated date of the game element information database D**2**.

[0129] Note that these databases can be successively downloaded via the game server **2** for addition to or change in the characters used in a game.

[0130] The processor **57** comprehensively controls the operation of the terminal **1** based on the programs and data stored in the storage **56**, and various input signals from the operation input **53**. The function of the processor **57** can be implemented by e.g., a microprocessor such as a CPU or a GPU, and electronic parts such as an ASIC, and an IC memory. As primary functional units, the processor **57** includes a player information manager **60**, a game execution controller **61**, a store presentation controller **62**, a direction presentation controller **63**, a deck former **64**, a play field presentation unit **65**, and a game card presentation unit **66**.

[0131] The player information manager **60** manages the information on players using the player information database D**1**. The player information manager **60** uses the player information database D**1** to manage game elements such as player information like a player ID and a player name, possessed game cards, in-game currency, and decks formed by a player. When those pieces of information are updated, the player information manager **60** updates the player information database D**1**, and records the update date.

[0132] The game execution controller **61** controls and managed the progress of the entire game. For example, the game execution controller **61** displays a menu screen of a home screen or the like, and performs a process selected by a player. FIG. **11** is a view illustrating an example of a home screen. The home screen in FIG. **11** displays a home screen tab **200** for the home screen, a deck tab **201** to make a transition to a deck screen for forming a deck, a store tab **202** to make a transition to a store screen for purchasing a game card, a fighting mode selection button **203** to select to fighting mode for a fight using a deck, a fighting button **204** to make a transition to a fight in the selected fighting mode, an icon **205**, a reward button **206** to make a transition to a reward screen related to reward of a mission, an in-game currency icon **207**, an in-game currency balance (amount of possession) icon **208**, and an in-game currency providing screen transition button **209** to make a transition to a purchase screen for in-game currency. Note that the in-game currency balance (amount of possession) icon **208** shows the total of paid-for currency units and free of charge currency units. On the icon **205**, the deck name of a deck currently selected, and the leader card included in the deck are displayed.

[0133] The game execution controller **61** executes a fighting game between players, and when victory or defeat of the game is determined, the player information, the level and the like of the player information database D**1** are updated with a fighting result, and the experience points, level, rank which have been changed by the fighting. The date of update is recorded on the field for last updated date as the last updated date.

[0134] When the store tab **202** for the home screen is selected, the store presentation controller **62** presents a store screen for trading the game elements (such as a game card, in-game currency) to selectably present the game elements to be traded on the store screen. FIGS. **12** and **13** are views illustrating an example of a store screen. FIG. **12** is an example of a store screen for purchasing a card pack (set of game cards), FIG. **13** is an example of a store screen for purchasing a starter deck (set of game cards), and providable (grantable) card packs are selectably presented. In the area of card packs, a name **210** of each card pack, and an option **211** for purchasing the card pack are displayed. Here, the provision (grant) includes obtaining by exchanging with a price by a player, and providing (granting) by an administration side without needing to pay for price.

[0135] The providable game elements include the ones provided with restrictions, and the ones provided without restrictions. The game elements with restrictions include, for example, the ones with restrictions on the number of times of provision (grant), and the ones which are providable (grantable) only in a predetermined time period. The restrictions on the number of times of provision (grant) of game element is, for example, restrictions on the number of times of provision for one player, or restrictions on the providable number of times of provision for all players. Also, game elements without restrictions on the provision (grant), and game elements with restrictions on the provision (grant) may be displayed collectively or singly. In the example of FIG. **12**, “XXX card pack” and “YYY card pack” have no restrictions on the number of times of provision, but “ZZZ card pack” and “SSS card pack” have restrictions on the number of times of provision. In the example of FIG. **13**, all of “AAA deck” “BBB deck” “CCC deck” and “DDD deck” have restrictions on the number of times of provision. In this manner, in addition to the game elements that are sold normally, the game elements that are provided (granted) only in a specific number or in a specific time period are supplied, thus the interest of each player to the game elements can be maintained continually.

[0136] In addition, the game elements presented on the store screen include not only currently tradable game elements, but also game elements which were providable in the past, but are currently untradable. The currently untradable game elements are, for example, the game elements when restrictions on the number of times of grant of game element are provided per player and the restricted limit is reached, or when the number of times of provision for all players is predetermined and the number of times of provision (grant) has reached the number (sold-out state). The store presentation controller **62** presents currently unprovidable game elements to a player to be distinguishable from currently providable game elements, so that the currently unprovidable game elements cannot be selected. FIG. **14** is a view illustrating an example of display of currently providable game elements and currently unprovidable game elements on the store screen. In the example of FIG. **14**, an area **220** for “AAA deck” and “CCC deck” in a sold-out state is expressed in black to be distinguishable from an area **221** for “BBB deck” and “DDD deck” in a providable state, and display of an option **211** for “AAA deck” and “CCC deck” is changed to “SOLD OUT” indicating a sold-out state, and presented as unselectable by a player. In this manner, currently untradable game elements are presented as unselectable, thereby the player can recognize the game elements provided in the past and do not select from the currently untradable game elements, thus the convenience of players is improved.

[0137] The store presentation controller **62** also provides or grants in-game currency. As illustrated in FIGS. **11** to **14**, instead of using transition to the in-game currency providing screen by a tab, the in-game currency icon **207**, the in-game currency balance icon **208** for the in-game currency of a player, and the in-game currency providing screen transition button **209** to make a transition to the in-game currency providing screen are displayed on each of the home screen caused by the home screen tab **200**, the deck formation screen caused by the deck tab **201**, and the store screen caused by the store tab **202**.

[0138] When one of the in-game currency icon **207** and the in-game currency balance icon **208** for the in-game currency of player is selected, the store presentation controller **62** refers to the field for possessed currency information of the player information database D**1**, and displays the breakdown between the paid-for and free of charge in-game currency units currently possessed by the player. FIG. **15** is a view illustrating an example of display of breakdown between paid-for and free of charge in-game currency units currently possessed. In the example of FIG. **15**, the balance of paid-for currency among the in-game currency currently possessed by the player, and the balance of free of charge currency among the in-game currency currently possessed by the player are displayed. As the price for purchasing a game element, it is displayed that free of charge currency is consumed preferentially, and paid-for currency is consumed from the oldest date of acquisition to the newest date.

[0139] In this manner, the in-game currency icon **207**, the in-game currency balance icon **208**, and the in-game currency providing screen transition button **209** are presented on each screen, thus the player can recognize the balance of the in-game currency currently possessed, and the breakdown between paid-for and free of charge in-game currency, thus can make a transition from each screen to the in-game currency providing screen for obtaining necessary in-game currency.

[0140] When the in-game currency providing screen transition button **209** is selected, the store presentation controller **62** makes a transition to the in-game currency providing screen. On the in-game currency providing screen, the store presentation controller **62** presents the currently providable in-game currency.

[0141] FIG. **16** is a view illustrating an example of the in-game currency providing screen. In the example of FIG. **16**, a first paid-for currency pack **231** and a second paid-for currency pack **232** are presented on the in-game currency providing screen. The first paid-for currency pack **231** costs **150** currency units for **100** yen, and the second paid-for currency pack **232** costs **100** currency units for **100** yen. Like this, the first paid-for currency pack **231** and the second paid-for currency pack **232** have different provided amounts for a predetermined price. In other words, the first paid-for currency pack **231** offers a better deal. However, there is an upper limit to the number of times of provision (grant) of the first paid-for currency pack **231** for one player. In the example of FIG. **16**, the upper limit to the number of times of provision (grant) of the first paid-for currency pack **231** is three for one player. In contrast, there is no upper limit to the number of times of provision (grant) of the second paid-for currency pack **232** for one player.

[0142] The store presentation controller **62** refers to the purchase history information of the player in the player information database D**1**, and when the upper limit of the number of times of provision (grant) of the first paid-for currency pack **231** is reached, notifies of a sold-out state due to this situation, and presents the first paid-for currency pack **231** as unselectable. FIG. **17** is a view illustrating an example of when the number of times of provision (grant) of the first paid-for currency pack **231** has reached an upper limit, resulting in a sold-out state.

[0143] As described above, in addition to the game elements that are sold normally, the game elements that are provided (granted) only in a specific number or in a specific time period are supplied, thus the interest of each player to the game elements can be maintained continually.

[0144] In addition, when a game element such as a game card is purchased on the store screen for purchasing game element, if the in-game currency (the total of the paid-for currency units and the free of charge currency units) for the price of the game element is insufficient, the store presentation controller **62** may notify of insufficiency of the in-game currency, and as a method to make a transition to the in-game currency providing screen, may display a screen from which a transition can be made to the in-game currency providing screen. FIG. **18** is a view illustrating an example of a screen to be displayed when the in-game currency for the price of a game element is insufficient. In the example of FIG. **18**, a notification **233** indicating that the in-game currency for the price of a game element is insufficient, and a button **234** which can make a transition to the in-game currency providing screen are displayed.
[0145] The direction presentation controller **63** orchestrates the direction for opening game elements such as game cards purchased on the store screen. In the present embodiment, a description will be given using an example of a set of game cards such as a card pack and a deck. As mentioned above, each game card has a rarity level, and the rarity is divided into five scales. In addition, each game card has an attribute such as leader card, and battle card. These game cards have their values, and a smaller number of game cards with a higher value is provided. A set such as a card pack is a set of multiple game cards having various value information such as these rarities and attributes. When purchasing a set (pack) such as a card pack, a player cannot tell the value of game elements such as game cards included in the pack. However, the player may find joy in knowing what kind of values are possessed by the game cards included in the purchased pack. Thus, a pack opening direction which reveals what kind of values are possessed by the game cards included in the purchased pack is an important direction that enhances the enjoyment of the game.
[0146] The direction presentation controller **63** performs an opening direction for a granted pack using the pack information transmitted when the pack is provided from the server **2**. The pack information includes the game element ID of each game element included in the pack. The direction presentation controller **63** obtains value information (such as rarity information, attribute information) of the game element ID in the pack information from the game element information database D**2**, and performs an opening direction for the pack according to the value information.
[0147] A specific example of an opening direction performed by the direction presentation controller **63** will be described below. In the following, a description will be given using an example of a game card pack including eight game cards as an instance of a set of game elements, and an example of rarity information as an instance of value information. FIGS. **27**A to **27**F show views for explaining an opening direction example.
[0148] The direction presentation controller **63** receives pack information on the pack provided from the server **2**. Here, the game element IDs of eight game cards included in the received pack information are assumed to be game element ID “2021”, game element ID “2056”, game element ID “2078”, game element ID “2088”, game element ID “2147”, game element ID “2159”, game element ID “2299”, and game element ID “2347”.
[0149] The direction presentation controller **63** obtains rarity information corresponding to the game element IDs from the game element information database D**2**. The rarity information corresponding to the game element IDs is as follows:
[0150] The rarity information for game element ID “2021” is “1”.
[0151] The rarity information for game element ID “2056” is “1”.
[0152] The rarity information for game element ID “2078” is “3”.
[0153] The rarity information for game element ID “2088” is “1”.
[0154] The rarity information for game element ID “2147” is “5”.
[0155] The rarity information for game element ID “2159” is “1”.
[0156] The rarity information for game element ID “2299” is “1”.
[0157] The rarity information for game element ID “2347” is “1”.
[0158] The direction presentation controller **63** pre-stores a threshold value for predetermined rarity

information, and performs a different direction depending on whether the rarity information of granted game cards exceeds the threshold value. In the following example, the threshold value for the rarity information is assumed to be “2”.

[0159] As a first stage direction, the direction presentation controller **63** selectably presents the eight game cards **301** to **308** with the back surfaces (character information is unrecognizable) having the same picture pattern shown. When the game cards **301** to **308** are leader cards, character information is written on both the front and back surfaces, but the back surfaces with the same picture pattern are displayed, where character information is formally unrecognizable from the back surfaces. For a game card with a threshold value exceeding “2”, the outer edge of the back surface of the game card is thickened (a first mode). In contrast, for a game card with a threshold value not exceeding “2”, the outer edge thereof has a normal thickness (a second mode). However, the game card having highest rarity information among game cards with a threshold value exceeding “2” is in the second mode as in a game card with a threshold value not exceeding “2”.

[0160] Specifically, in the game cards **301** to **308** of FIGS. **27**A to **27**F, the game card **301** corresponds to the game element ID “2021” with rarity information “1”, the game card **302** corresponds to the game element ID “2056” with rarity information “1”, the game card **303** corresponds to the game element ID “2078” with rarity information “3”, the game card **304** corresponds to the game element ID “2088” with rarity information “1”, the game card **305** corresponds to the game element ID “2147” with rarity information “5”, the game card **306** corresponds to game element ID “2159” with rarity information “1”, the game card **307** corresponds to game element ID “2299” with rarity information “1”, and the game card **308** corresponds to game element ID “2347” with rarity information “1”. Among the game cards **301** to **308**, the game cards with a threshold value exceeding “2” are the game card **303** and the game card **305**. The game card **305** has the highest rarity information.

[0161] The direction presentation controller **63** indicates that the game card **303** has high rarity information in the first mode in which the outer edge of the back surface of the game card **303** is thickened. In contrast, other game cards excluding the game card **303** are presented in the second mode (FIG. **27**A).

[0162] A player selects one of game cards presented. The direction presentation controller **63** performs a second stage direction for the selected game card.

[0163] Here, the player is assumed to select the game card **302** (FIG. **27**B). As the second stage direction, the direction presentation controller **63** performs a first direction (one flip) in which the game card **302** is turned back to front, and displays the front surface of the game card **302**, so that the character information is recognizable (FIG. **27**C).

[0164] Next, the player is assumed to select the game card **303** (FIG. **27**C)). As the second stage direction, the direction presentation controller **63** performs a direction (one flip) in which the game card **303** is turned back to front, and displays the front surface of the game card **303**, so that the character information is recognizable (FIG. **27**D). At this point, the outer edge of the game card **303** is in the first mode which indicates high rarity information.

[0165] Furthermore, the player is assumed to select the game card **305** (FIG. **27**D). As the second stage direction, the direction presentation controller **63** performs a direction in which the game card **305** is turned back to front. The game card **305** is the game card having the highest rarity information of “5”. Thus, when direction of turning the game card **305** back to front is performed, the direction presentation controller **63** increases the number of flips (for example, two flips) to perform the second direction in order to indicate that the game card **305** is different from the other game cards (FIG. **27**E). The direction presentation controller **63** displays the front surface of the game card **305**, so that the character information is recognizable (FIG. **27**F). At this point, the outer edge of the game card **305** is in the first mode which indicates high rarity information. The above operation is performed until all the game cards are selected.

[0166] In this manner, as a method for direction of opening the game cards, a first direction method performed when rarity information does not exceed a threshold value, a second direction method performed when rarity information exceeds a threshold value, and a third direction method performed on a special game card when rarity information exceeds a threshold value are combined to perform direction of opening the game cards, thereby implementing a direction that is unexpected to the player and enhances the enjoyment of the game.

[0167] Note that in the above description, the first mode has one type, but may have multiple types according to the size of rarity information. For example, the color for outer edge may be determined for each rarity information, and the outer edge of each game card with the rarity information may have the color. In addition, the color for outer edge may be different according to the attribute of the game card.

[0168] The third direction method is performed on the game card having the highest rarity information, but is not limited thereto, and may be performed on game cards having multiple pieces of rarity information, or performed on game cards based on a combination of rarity information and attribute information. The first direction method and the second direction method may be applied for rarity information, and the third direction method may be applied to a special game card, for example, a leader card.

[0169] The deck former **64** presents a deck formation screen, and forms a deck from the possessed game cards. The deck is formed by predetermined number of leader cards **21**, battle cards **22**, and extra cards **23** (hereinafter may be collectively referred to as game cards). For example, when each game element is a virtual game card displayed on a computer, a deck is a card group consisting of a predetermined number of game cards. In the present embodiment, a configurable deck includes the game cards selected by a player. The player forms a deck using possessed game cards in advance, and executes a game. When a deck is formed, the total number of cards in the deck and the number of cards of each type are predetermined. In the present embodiment, the total number of game cards included in the deck is 30 or more and 35 or less, but not limited thereto. The game cards included in the deck always include one leader card **21**, and the other game cards are the battle cards **22** and the extra cards **23** with the same color information as that of the leader card **21**.

[0170] The deck formation screen presented by the deck former **64** will be described. FIG. **33** is a view illustrating an example of the deck formation screen. The deck formation screen includes a first area **401**, a second area **402**, a third area **403**, and a fourth area **404**. The first area **401** is the area where the leader card **21** included in the deck is displayed. The second area **402** is the area where the battle cards **22** and the extra cards **23** included in the deck are displayed. The third area **403** is the area where the leader cards **21**, battle cards **22** and extra cards **23** possessed by the player are displayed. The fourth area is the area for displaying the detailed information on game cards selected from the game cards displayed in the first area **401**, the second area **402**, and the third area **403**. The first area **401** and the second area **402** are vertically adjacent to each other, the first area **401** is disposed in an upper part, and the second area **402** is disposed in a lower part. The third area **403** is disposed adjacent to the first area **401** and the second area **402**. The fourth area is disposed adjacent to the third area **403**.

[0171] The deck former **64** reads the possessed game element IDs and the number of possessions from the player information database D**1**, and reads character information (including image information) corresponding to the game element IDs from the game element information database D**2**. The deck former **64** then displays, on the third area **403**, the front surface (display surface of the character information) of one of game cards of each type in the leader card **21**, battle cards **22** and extra cards **23** possessed by the player based on the read character information regardless of the number of possessions, and displays the number of possessions below the one game card. The player can place a desired leader card **21** in the first area **401** by selecting the leader card **21** from the displayed game cards in the third area **403**, and moving (dragging and dropping) the leader card **21** to the first area **401**. Similarly, the player can place a desired battle card **22** or extra card **23** in the second area **402** by selecting the battle card **22** or extra card **23** from the displayed game cards in the third area **403**, and moving (dragging and dropping) the battle card **22** or extra card **23** to the second area **402**. Note that the third area **403** is provided with the function of scroll **405**, and scrolling allows all the leader card **21**, battle cards **22** and extra cards **23** possessed by the player to be checked in the third area **403**.

[0172] Next, the first area **401** and the second area **402** will be described in detail. FIG. **34** is a view for explaining the first area **401** and the second area **402**. The deck former **64** displays, in the first area **401**, a front surface **411** and a back surface **412** of the leader card **21** selected from the third area **403**. The front surface **411** and the back surface **412** of the leader card **21** are fixed, and their sizes and placement positions cannot be changed. Note that only one type leader card can be displayed in the first area **401**. The deck former **64** sets the background color of the first area to the same color as the attribute color (color information **114**) of the leader card placed.

[0173] The deck former **64** displays, in the second area **402**, the battle cards **22** or extra cards **23** selected from the third area **403** with the number of cards for each type presented. For each type of the cards, the deck former **64** displays card format images with part of the cards of the type superimposed. A format in which the card format images are superimposed is referred to as a first format. For example, there are three same game cards **421** included in the deck, thus the first format in which the three game cards **421** are stacked with the front surfaces up, and the number of game cards, "×3" below the game cards **421** are displayed in the second area **402**. Similarly, there are four same game cards **422** included in the deck, thus the first format in which the four game cards **422** are stacked with the front surfaces up, and the number of game cards, "×4" below the game cards **422** are displayed in the second area **402**. Similarly, there are five same game cards **423** included in the deck, thus the first format in which the five game cards **423** are stacked with the front surfaces up, and the number of game cards, "×5" below the game cards **423** are displayed in the second area **402**. Note that the horizontal size of the first format increases with the number of game cards. For example, the horizontal size of the game cards **421** is "a", the horizontal size of the game cards **422** is "b", and the horizontal size of the game cards **423** is "c", where a relationship of a<b<c holds.

[0174] However, when the number of same cards increases, the horizontal size becomes too large, and results in a smaller area where the game cards can be placed, thus the game cards greater in number than a predetermined number are displayed as a predetermined number of game cards in the first format. In the present embodiment, the predetermined number of game cards is five. For example, the number of the game cards **424** included in the deck is seven, which exceeds the predetermined number 5. Thus, for the game cards **424**, the first format with five cards, and the number of game cards, "×7" below the first format are displayed in the second area **402**. Therefore, the horizontal size of the game cards **424** and the horizontal size of the game cards **423** are the same, which is "c".

[0175] The deck former **64** singly displays each of special game cards among the battle cards **22** or the extra cards **23** selected from the third area **403** without displaying each special game card in the first format regardless of the number of same game cards. This display format is referred to as a second format. The special game cards are e.g., a game card with a high rarity, or a parallel card and a premium card which are associated with the same character information as that of normal game cards, but have a different picture pattern. A game card **425** is a special game card, thus is displayed in the second format.

[0176] For placement of the game cards in the second area **402**, maximum numbers of rows and columns for placing the game cards are set in advance. The maximum numbers of rows and columns are determined based on the type and number of game cards that can form a deck. In the present embodiment, the total number of game cards that can form a deck is 30 or more and 35 or less, thus as illustrated in FIG. **34**, 5 rows and 7 columns are set, a maximum of 35 types can be placed when each special card is counted as one type, and a maximum of 35 game cards can be placed when each type is counted as one game card. In the initial presentation of game cards, the deck former **64** displays the game cards forming a deck in the first format and the second format with the maximum numbers of rows and columns so that the game cards forming the deck is visible as a list. Note that when the initial game cards are displayed, the number of rows and the number of columns may be changed as appropriate according to the types and the number of game cards forming the deck.

[0177] When the initial game cards are displayed, the game cards forming the deck are preferably visible as a list, but the display size of the game cards may be reduced. Thus, the deck former **64** has a function of displaying enlarged images of the game cards forming the deck. As illustrated in FIG. **34**, the deck former **64** displays an enlargement button **431** in the second area, and when the enlargement button **431** is selected, the deck former **64** decreases the number of rows and the number of columns in the second area, and displays the game cards.

[0178] FIG. **35** is a view for explaining a function of enlarging the game cards in the second area. When the enlargement button **431** is selected, the deck former **64** changes the placement of the game cards from 5 rows by 7 columns to 2 rows by 3 columns so that the display of each type game card is enlarged. At this point, the reduction in the number of rows and the number of columns produces invisible game cards, so to make those game cards visible, a scroll **433** is displayed to allow all the game cards forming the deck to be viewed. When a reduction button **432** is selected, the deck former **64** returns the placement to maximum 5 rows and 7 columns again to allow all the game cards forming the deck to be viewed. Note that in the example of FIG. **35**, two stages of enlargement and reduction are provided, but more stages of enlargement and reduction, such as 3 stages or 4 stages, may be further provided. In this case, in an intermediate stage, the enlargement button **431** and the reduction button **432** are displayed at the same time to allow a transition to each stage.

[0179] When a deck formation work by a player is finished, and a save button **433** is selected, the deck former **64** registers a deck in association with a deck name **434**, the deck consisting of the leader card **21** placed in the first area **401**, and the battle cards **22** and the extra cards **23** placed in the second area **402**.

[0180] At the registration of the deck, the deck former **64** alerts the player when a deck unusable in a fighting game is attempted to be formed. In the present embodiment, the conditions (deck non-conforming criteria) for unusable deck in a fighting game are as follows: [0181] (1) The number of game cards (the total number of game cards placed in the second area) forming the deck is less than 30. [0182] (2) The number of game cards (the total number of game cards placed in the second area) forming the deck is greater than 35. [0183] (3) The number of limited game cards (game cards having a special ability or skill) which can be included in the deck exceeds a restricted limit according to a game rule. [0184] (4) The number of game cards of the same type exceeds a predetermined number. [0185] (5) The deck includes a game card which is not possessed by the player. [0186] (6) The deck does not include a leader card (no leader card **21** is present in the first area **401**). [0187] (7) The deck includes a game card with an attribute color different from the attribute color of the leader card (a game card with an attribute color different from the attribute color of the leader card is placed in the second area **402**). These deck non-conforming criteria are an example, and other conditions may be added as appropriate.

[0188] When the save button **433** is selected, the deck former **64** determines whether the deck formation constructed with the game cards placed in the first area **401** and the second area **402** satisfies any of the deck non-conforming criteria. When the deck formation satisfies one of the deck non-conforming criteria, the deck former **64** notifies of the event. For example, when the deck non-conforming criteria are satisfied in part, the deck former **64** notifies of the following messages. [0189] (1) When the number of game cards (the total number of game cards placed in the second area) forming the deck is less than 30, a pop-up text “Unusable for fighting because the number of cards in the deck is insufficient. Save the deck?” is displayed as a pop-up. [0190] (2) When the number of game cards (the total number of game cards placed in the second area) forming the deck is greater than 35, a pop-up text "Unusable for fighting because the number of cards in the deck exceeds a limit. Save the deck?" is displayed as a pop-up. [0191] (3) When the number of limited game cards (game cards having a special ability or skill) which can be included in the deck exceeds a restricted limit according to a game rule, "Unusable for fighting because the number of limited game cards exceeds a restricted limit. Save the deck?" is displayed as a pop-up. [0192] (4) When the number of game cards of the same type exceeds a predetermined number, "Unusable for fighting because the number of game cards of the same type exceeds a predetermined number. Save the deck?" is displayed as a pop-up. [0193] (5) When the deck includes a game card which is not possessed by the player, "Unusable for fighting because a game card not possessed is used to form the deck. Save the deck?" is displayed as a pop-up. [0194] (6) When the deck does not include a leader card (no leader card **21** is present in the first area **401**), "Unusable for fighting because a leader card is not used to form the deck. Save the deck?" is displayed as a pop-up. [0195] (7) When the deck includes a game card with an attribute color different from the attribute color of the leader card (a game card with an attribute color different from the attribute color of the leader card is placed in the second area **402**), "Unusable for fighting because a card with a color different from the color of the leader card is used to form the deck. Save the deck?" is displayed as a pop-up. [0196] FIG. **36** is an example of popup display when the formed deck satisfies (7) deck non-conforming criterion.

[0197] Note that the deck non-conforming criteria may have a priority order. For example, a higher priority order is given to the condition, such as (6) a leader card is not present and (7) when the deck includes a game card with an attribute color different from the attribute color of the leader card, in which the game itself cannot be played, whereas a lower priority order is given to the condition, such as restrictions on the number of game cards forming the deck, in which the player has a disadvantage. According to the priority order, the player may be notified of satisfied deck non-conforming criteria successively. When the formed deck satisfies multiple deck non-conforming criteria, the player is preferably notified of all the multiple deck non-conforming criteria, but may be notified of only part thereof.

[0198] Because (3), (4) and (5) deck non-conforming conditions can be determined by the deck former **64** even in a deck formation process before registration of the deck, the deck former **64** may notify the player of the conditions accordingly. FIG. **37** is a view illustrating an example of display when a formed deck satisfies a deck non-conforming condition. As illustrated in FIG. **37**, when a game card in the second area **402** satisfies a non-conforming condition, an alert icon **440** or notification **441** for the game card may be displayed.

[0199] The deck former **64** registers, in the deck information database D**20**, a deck not satisfying any deck non-conforming condition and usable for a fighting game as a conforming deck, and registers, in the deck information database D**20**, a deck satisfying one of the deck non-conforming conditions and unusable for a fighting game as a non-conforming deck. FIG. **38** is an example of the deck information database D**20**. The deck information database D**20** includes a field for deck ID, a field for deck name, a field for conformity/non-conformity, and a field for game element ID included in a deck. For a registered or saved deck, the deck former **64** records, in the deck information database D**20**, the deck ID, the deck name, conformity/non-conformity of the deck, the game element IDs of the game cards included in the deck with the date of update. The deck former **64** transmits the content of the deck information database D**20** to the game server **2**.

[0200] The deck former **64** can display a deck list screen including information on the deck names and conformity/non-conformity of the registered decks. FIG. **39** is an example of a registration deck list screen. Selecting one of the decks displayed as a list causes return to the deck formation screen, and the selected deck can be formed again.

[0201] The play field presentation unit **65** presents a play field. Here, the play field will be described. FIG. **40** is a view illustrating an example of a play field presented by the play field presentation unit **65**.

[0202] The play field is assigned a plurality of areas. The plurality of areas indicate the places where a player places game cards, and are arranged with space having a predetermined width. In the following description, the play field includes a leader area **501** of the player and a leader area **502** of the opponent player, a battle area **503** of the player and a battle area **504** of the opponent player, a life area **505** of the player and a life area **506** of the opponent player, an energy area **507** of the player and an energy area **508** of the opponent player, a hand of cards area **509** of the player and a hand of cards area **510** of the opponent player, a deck area **511** of the player and a deck area **512** of the opponent player, and a drop area **513** of the player and a drop area **514** of the opponent player. However, to enhance the direction performance, the boundary line of each area is not clearly shown except for the battle areas. These area names may be any name as long as each player can understand them.
[0203] Each area may be labeled with a name; however, in the present embodiment, instead of a name, an icon indicating the area is presented. In the present embodiment, the play field displays an icon **521** indicating the leader area **501** of the player, an icon **522** indicating the leader area **502** of the opponent player, an icon **523** indicating the battle area **503** of the player, an icon **524** indicating the battle area **504** of the opponent player, an icon **525** indicating the life area **505** of the player, an icon **526** indicating the life area **506** of the opponent player, an icon **527** indicating the energy area **507** of the player, an icon **528** indicating the energy area **508** of the opponent player, an icon **529** indicating the hand of cards area **509** of the player, an icon **530** indicating the hand of cards area **510** of the opponent player, an icon **531** indicating the deck area **511** of the player, an icon **532** indicating the deck area **512** of the opponent player, an icon **533** indicating the drop area **513** of the player, and an icon **534** indicating the drop area **514** of the opponent player.
[0204] The leader area **501** of the player and the leader area **502** of the opponent player are areas where the leader cards **21** are placed. However, these areas are different from other areas, and the character images of characters which have transformed into the leader cards **21** are displayed.
[0205] The battle area **503** of the player and the battle area **504** of the opponent player are areas where the battle cards **22** or the extra cards **23** of the player and the opponent player are placed. In the battle area **503** and the battle area **504**, the character information of the card images of the placed battle cards **22** or extra cards **23** is displayed.
[0206] Although the battle cards **22** or the extra cards **23** are placed in the life area **505** of the player and the life area **506** of the opponent player, their card images are not displayed, and the number of placed cards is displayed (for example, Life 8).
[0207] The energy area **507** of the player and the energy area **508** of the opponent player are areas where one battle card **22** or one extra card **23** is placed from the hand of cards for each turn. The character information of the card image of the placed battle card **22** or extra card **23** is displayed.
[0208] The hand of cards area **509** of the player and the hand of cards area **510** of the opponent player are areas where a hand of cards selected from the deck of the player or the opponent player is placed. The character information of the card image of the placed battle card **22** or extra card **23** is displayed.
[0209] The deck area **511** of the player and the deck area **512** of the opponent player are areas where the deck of the player or the opponent player is placed. In these deck areas, the card images of the placed battle cards **22** or extra cards **23** are not displayed, and the number of remaining cards in the deck is displayed.
[0210] The drop area **513** of the player and the drop area **514** of the opponent player are areas where the battle card **22** is placed which has been attacked by the battle card **22** of the opponent player and knocked out (KO). The card images of the placed battle cards **22** or extra cards **23** are not displayed, and the number of cards is displayed.
[0211] When the above-described play field is presented, the play field presentation unit **65** does not display any boundary line other than the boundary line between the battle area **503** and the battle area **504** of the opponent player. This is due to consideration of the appearance of the play

field. Alternatively, another area may be provided.

[0212] From a formed deck or hand of cards, the game card presentation unit **66** places game cards in each area and displays them. However, when the game cards are placed, the presentation format is different for each area. The areas are divided into disclosed areas and undisclosed areas. In the disclosed areas, the content (character information) of the game cards can be identified by both the player and the opponent player. In the undisclosed areas, the content (character information) of the game cards cannot be identified by at least one of the player or the opponent player. The disclosed areas are the leader areas **501**, **502**, the battle areas **503**, **504**, the energy areas **507**, **508**, and the drop areas **513**, **514**. In contrast, the undisclosed areas are the life areas **505**, **506**, the hand of cards areas **509**, **510**, and the deck areas **511**, **512**. Particularly, in the life areas **505**, **506** and the deck areas **511**, **512**, both the player and the opponent player cannot identify the content (character information) of the game cards.

[0213] When placing game cards in a disclosed area, the game card presentation unit **66** presents the game cards so that the character information of the game cards is visible. For example, as in the game cards placed in the battle areas **503**, **504** of FIG. **40**, the game card presentation unit **66** presents the front surfaces (display surfaces of the character information) of the game cards. In contrast, in the hand of cards areas **509**, **510** which are undisclosed areas, as in the hand of cards areas **509**, **510** of FIG. **41**, the game card presentation unit **66** presents game cards so that the character information of the game cards is visible to only one of the player or the opponent player. For the game cards placed in the life areas **505**, **506** and the deck areas **511**, **512** which are undisclosed areas, the images of the game cards are not presented, and only the number of the game cards is presented. This is because the cards with character information invisible to both the player and the opponent player do not need to be displayed in a card format so as to occupy the play field.

[0214] In addition, the game card presentation unit **66** has a function of presenting a viewing screen which allows the game cards placed in the areas to be viewed. Here, the viewing screen presented by the game card presentation unit **66** will be described.

[0215] When one of the icons in the areas of the play field is selected by the player, the game card presentation unit **66** presents a viewing screen **540** on the play field. FIG. **42** is an example of the viewing screen **540** presented on the play field. The viewing screen **540** in FIG. **42** is an example viewing screen **540** when the icon **523** in the battle area of the player is selected.

[0216] The viewing screen **540** will be described in detail with reference to FIG. **43**. The viewing screen **540** includes an icon display section **541** for the areas, an area name **542** of the currently selected area, a distinguished range **543** for distinguishing the range of the game cards placed in the selected area, and a scroll bar **544** to scroll the game cards horizontally.

[0217] The viewing screen **540** in FIG. **43** is the one when the battle area is selected, thus “battle area” is displayed as the area name **542**, and the game cards placed in the battle area of the player are displayed in the distinguished range **543**. The game card presentation unit **66** presents partially overlapping game cards on a line, and displays the game cards in the distinguished range **543** in a large size to be distinguishable from the game cards placed in other areas.

[0218] When another icon in the icon display section **541** is selected with the viewing screen **540** displayed, the game card presentation unit **66** can also display, in the distinguished range **543**, the game elements placed in the area of the selected icon. The example of FIG. **43** illustrates a case where “energy area” is selected in a state where “battle area” is selected. Furthermore, when the icon for the deck area is selected in a state where “energy area” is selected, a transition is made to the game cards placed in the deck area. However, since the deck area is an undisclosed area, the card images of the back surfaces are displayed, from which the character information of the placed game cards is invisible.

[0219] The game card presentation unit **66** displays moving game cards by moving the bar of the scroll bar **544**. For example, the cards are scrolled to the right side by moving the scroll bar **544** to the left, and the cards are scrolled to the left side by moving the scroll bar **544** to the right. The game card presentation unit **66** shows the icon for an area according to a moving position, displays the game cards in the area in a large size within the distinguished range **543**, and displays the other game cards in a small size. Note that the scroll bar **544** may be displayed only when the number of game cards needed to be presented exceeds a predetermined number, in other words, only when the number of game cards needed to be presented exceeds a number of cards which are undisplayable within the distinguished range **543**.

[0220] The viewing screen **540** can have not only the game card viewing function, but also a selection function of presenting the game cards in a state (actionable state) where placement to another area is allowed and ability can be exhibited, and the selectable number of game cards among the game cards displayed within the distinguished range **543**. FIGS. **44** and **45** are views for explaining the selection function of the viewing screen **540**. FIGS. **44** and **45** illustrate an example of the viewing screen **540** presented when the icon for energy area is selected. In the energy area, the game cards usable as energy and the game cards unusable as energy in a certain turn are present. In this situation, the game card presentation unit **66** displays the selectable game cards normally and the unselectable game cards in dark background. Thus, the player can easily identify the selectable game cards and the unselectable game cards.

[0221] In addition, the game card presentation unit **66** can display the number **550** of selectable cards in actionable game elements on the viewing screen **540**. The example of FIG. **45** shows a case where the number of selectable cards is three. When the player selects one game card, the game card is moved above the other game cards and displayed to clarify that the game card has been selected. At this point, the selected game card is placed at the top of stacked cards so that the entire surface of the selected game card is displayed. When selection of the first game card is finished, the number of selected cards is incremented by one and displayed. When the second game card is further selected by the player, the game card is moved above the other game cards and displayed as in the selection of the first card. At this point, the selected game card is placed at the top of stacked cards so that the entire surface of the selected game card is displayed. When selection of the second game card is finished, the number of selected cards is incremented by one and displayed. Such display continues until the selectable number of cards is reached. Note that the appearance of the selected game card may be changed, for example, the boundary line may be highlighted to allow the selected game card to be easily distinguishable from the other game cards.

[0222] The game card presentation unit **66** has a function of displaying enlarged or reduced hand of cards. As illustrated in FIG. **41**, the game card presentation unit **66** displays a hand of cards **560** of the player in the hand of cards area. In consideration of identifiability of the situation of the play field, the game card presentation unit **66** displays adjacently overlapping game cards in the hand of cards area in a small size in a row, and a lower portion of the displayed image is cut off. Consequently, it is possible to check the overall picture of the hand of cards while grasping the situation of the entire play field.

[0223] Upon an operation (for example, clicking or touching) to an area other than the area where the hand of cards **560** of the player is presented, the game card presentation unit **66** displays the hand of cards with magnification. FIG. **46** is a view illustrating an example when the hand of cards is enlarged. In the example of FIG. **46**, a hand of cards **561** is displayed by arranging adjacently overlapping game cards in a fan shape in a row in a size larger than the hand of cards **560**.

[0224] In addition, the game card presentation unit **66** has a function of switching between display of reduced hand of cards **560** and display of enlarged hand of cards **561**. FIG. **47** shows views for explaining the switching between reduced display and enlarged display. A transition from the display of reduced hand of cards **560** to the display of enlarged hand of cards **561** can be made by an operation (for example, clicking or touching) to an area other than the area where the reduced hand of cards **560** is presented. A transition from the display of enlarged hand of cards **561** to the display of reduced hand of cards **560** can be made by an operation (for example, clicking or touching) to an area other than the area where the enlarged hand of cards **561** is presented. In this manner, switching between reduction and enlargement of display of the hand of cards is made.

[0225] When the reduced hand of cards **560** and the enlarged hand of cards **561** are displayed, the game card presentation unit **66** displays the game cards in the hand of cards to allow selection from the game cards. When a game card is selected, as illustrated in FIGS. **48** and **49**, to clarify the selected game card, the game card presentation unit **66** moves the game card above the other game cards to display the game card. At this point, the selected game card is placed at the top of stacked cards so that the entire surface of the selected game card is displayed. The appearance of the selected game card may be changed, for example, the boundary line may be highlighted to allow the selected game card to be easily distinguishable from the other game cards.

[0226] Furthermore, when a game card is selected with reduced hand of cards **560** or enlarged hand of cards **561** displayed, if the game card is in a state (actionable state) where placement to another area is allowed and ability can be exhibited, the game card presentation unit **66** has a function of displaying icons indicating the actions (selectable actions) which can be selected. FIG. **50** is a view illustrating an example of display of selectable actions. In the example of FIG. **50**, two selectable actions "play card in battle area" and "play card in energy area" are presented as the selectable actions of the selected game card, and selecting the icon for a selectable action allows the selected game card to make a transition to the action.

Configuration of Game Server **2**

[0227] FIG. **19** is a block diagram illustrating a functional configuration example of the game server **2**. The game server **2** includes a processor **70**, a communicator **71**, and a storage **72**.

[0228] The processor **70** comprehensively controls the operation of the game server **2** based on the programs, data stored in the storage **72**, and received information and the like. The function of the processor **70** can be implemented by e.g., a microprocessor such as a CPU or a GPU, and electronic parts such as an ASIC, an IC memory. The processor **70** has the functions of a player information manager **80**, a game execution manager **81**, a store manager **82**, and a pack manager **83**.

[0229] The player information manager **80** manages the information on players using the user information management database D**3**. FIG. **20** is a table illustrating an example of the user information management database D**3**. The user information management database D**3** has one record for each player, and the record is similar to the user information database D**1**.

[0230] The player information manager **80** checks the player ID and the last updated date of the user information database D**1** transmitted at the login to a game via the player terminal **1** with the player ID and the last updated date of the user information management database D**3**. When the last updated dates match, a notification of the match is transmitted, and when the last updated dates do not match, synchronization of the content of the user information database D**1** is achieved between the player terminal **1** and the game server **2** by transmitting the information registered in the user information management database D**3**.

[0231] The game execution manager **81** grants and manages various parameters such as experience points based on matching between players, execution of a fighting game, and the result of the fighting game. The game execution manager **81** uses the game element management database D**4** to manage various game elements such as the game cards used in games. FIG. **21** is a table illustrating an example of the game element management database D**4**. The game element management database D**4** has information similar to the game element database D**4** stored in each player terminal **1**. The game execution manager **81** updates the game element database D**4** due to appearance of a new game element. At the time of login via the player terminal **1**, synchronization of the content of the game element database D**2** is achieved between the player terminal **1** and the game server **2**.

[0232] The store manager **82** manages a store that provides game elements using the store management database D**5**. FIG. **22** is a table illustrating an example of the store management database D**5**. In the example of FIG. **22**, one record includes a field for game element ID to identify the game element to be provided, a field for the game element, a field for price (in-game currency) of the game element, a field for restrictions on the provision of the game element, and a field for stock of the game element.

[0233] In the field for game element ID, not only the game element ID of a game card or in-game currency itself is written, but also a game card pack (also including a deck) which is a set of multiple game cards, and identification information for an in-game currency pack which is a set of in-game currencies are written. Note that for a game card pack, the content of included game cards may be different even with the same identification information. In such a situation, a list of the game card IDs of the game cards (game cards which may be included in the game card pack) associated with the identification information for the game card pack is stored. At the time of provision to a player, the store manager **82** selects as many game card IDs as the number of cards in the game card pack from the list by drawing lots, and a set of the game cards with the selected game card IDs is provided as a game card pack. In the field for restrictions on provision, the content of restrictions on provision of the game element is written. As the restrictions on provision, for example, the number of times of provision (grant) of a game element, and a providable period are written. In the field for stock, when the number of times of provision are not restricted, "present" is written, and when the number of times of provision for all players are restricted, "the number of stocks" is written.

[0234] The store manager **82** receives a request from the player terminal **1**, reads, from the store management database D**5**, the information on the game element to be provided, and transmits the information as store information.

[0235] The pack manager **83** uses a pack information database D**10** to select a game element included in the purchased pack by drawing lots, and transmits pack information including the game ID of the selected game element to the player terminal **1**.

[0236] FIG. **28** is a table illustrating an example of the pack information database D**10**. For each game element ID to identify the pack, a field for game element ID to identify the game elements which may be included in the pack, a field for attribute, and a field for rarity information are provided. The field for attribute is for recording the attribute of a game card such as a leader card. The field for rarity information is for recording rarity information of a game card on a scale of 1 to 5. The number of game element IDs of the game cards with the game element ID of one pack, included in the pack information database D**10** is at least greater than or equal to the number of game cards included in the one pack. A game card with the game element ID of one pack included in the pack information database D**10** for is less common when the game card is with higher value information, and is more common when the game card is with lower value information. Thus, when a game card is selected at random, a game card with higher value information has a lower probability of being selected, and a game card with lower value information has a higher probability of being selected.

[0237] From the pack information database D**10** for the game element ID of the pack purchased by a player, the pack manager **83** randomly selects as many game element IDs as the number of game cards included in the pack by drawing lots. In the present embodiment, the number of game cards included in the pack is eight, thus the pack manager **83** selects eight game element IDs by drawing lots from the pack information database D**10**. The pack manager **83** then generates pack information including the game element ID of the purchased pack, and the game element IDs of the game elements selected by drawing lots, and transmits the pack information to the player terminal **1**. A deck registration unit **84** receives the content of the deck information database D**20** transmitted from the deck former **64** of the player terminal **1**, and updates the deck information database D**20** stored in the storage **72** with the updated date. Note that the deck information database D**20** is similar to the deck information database D**20** of the player terminal **1**.

[0238] The communicator **71** connects to the communication line N to establish communication.

[0239] The storage **72** stores a system program and a game program. The system program implements the basic functions of the game server **2** as a computer. The game program causes the processor **70** to function as the player information manager **80**, the game execution manager **81**, the store manager **82**, the pack manager **83**, and the deck registration unit **84**.

[0240] In addition, a recorder **72** stores the user information management database D**3**, the game element management database D**4**, the store management database D**5**, and the deck information database D**20**.

Operation of Each Device

[0241] The operation of the player terminal **1** and the game server **2** will be described. FIG. **23** is a sequence diagram for explaining the operation of the player terminal **1** and the game server **2**. In the following, a description will be given assuming that a player has completed the initial setting for the game, and a player ID has been granted to the player.

[0242] When a player starts a game application of the player terminal **1**, the game execution controller **61** transmits the player ID of the player, and the last updated date of the player information database D**1** and the game element database D**2** to the game server **2** (Step **1**).

[0243] The player information manager **80** of the game server **2** checks the last updated date of the received player ID with the last updated date of the player ID of the player information management database D**3** (Step **2**). When the last updated dates match, the player information manager **80** transmits a notification of the match. In contrast, when the last updated dates do not match, the player information manager **80** transmits each information stored in the record of the player ID of the player information management database D**3** (Step **3**). Thus, player information is synchronized between the player terminal **1** and the game server **2**. Similarly, the player information manager **80** checks the last updated date of the game element database D**2** with the last updated date of the game element management database D**4**, and when the last updated dates do not match, transmits each information of the game element management database D**4**. Thus, game element information is synchronized between the player terminal **1** and the game server **2**. Note that the information transmitted from the game server **2** may be information on the difference between the player terminal **1** and the game server **2**.

[0244] The player information manager **60** and the game execution controller **61** of the player terminal **1** receive notification of database from the game server **2**, and update the player information database D**1** and the game element information database D**2** as necessary (Step **4**).

[0245] The store presentation controller **62** of the player terminal **1** displays the home screen illustrated in FIG. **11**, and requests the game server **2** for store information (Step **5**).

[0246] The store manager **82** of the game server **2** receives the request from the player terminal **1**, reads, from the store management database D**5**, each information of the game element to be provided, and transmits the information as the store information (Step **6**).

[0247] The store presentation controller **62** of the player terminal **1** receives the store information. For a game element with restrictions on provision among the game elements of the store information, the store presentation controller **62** checks the restrictions on provision with the purchase history information of the player information database D**1**, and determines whether the game element is providable (grantable) or unprovidable (ungrantable) (Step **7**). When the store tab **202** is selected, the store presentation controller **62** presents providable (grantable) game elements, and unprovidable (ungrantable) game elements in a distinguishable format, presents providable (grantable) game elements as selectable, and presents unprovidable (ungrantable) game elements as unselectable (Step **8**).

[0248] FIG. **24** shows tables for explaining determination as to whether each game element is providable (grantable) or unprovidable (ungrantable). FIG. **24** illustrates the received store information, and the purchase history information of the player information database D**1**. The store presentation controller **62** determines whether a game element ID with restrictions on provision in the received store information has been registered in the purchase history information. In the example of FIG. **24**, “bargain product” with a game element ID “1001”, “FFF pack” with a game element ID “1002”, . . . , “AAA deck” with a game element ID “1010”, . . . , and “CCC deck” with a game element ID “1012” have restrictions on provision. In contrast, in the purchase history information, “AAA deck” with a game element ID “1010”, “CCC deck” with a game element ID “1012”, and “bargain product” with a game element ID “**1001**” have one-time purchase history.

[0249] On the screen for the starter deck on the store screen, as illustrated in FIG. **14**, the store presentation controller **62** presents the area **220** for “AAA deck” and “CCC deck” in a sold-out state expressed in black, which is distinguishable from the area **221** for “BBB deck” and “DDD deck” in a providable state, and changes the display of the option **211** for “AAA deck” and “CCC deck” to “SOLD OUT” indicating a sold-out state, thereby presenting the option **211** as unselectable by the player.

[0250] The “bargain product” with a game element ID “1001” has been purchased once, and the upper limit of restricted number of times of purchase has not been reached. Therefore, when the in-game currency providing screen transition button **209** to make a transition to the in-game currency providing screen is selected on any screen, as illustrated in FIG. **16**, the store presentation controller **62** presents the paid-for currency pack **231** as the “bargain product” and the paid-for currency pack **232** on the in-game currency providing screen.

[0251] The store presentation controller **62** grants a game element to the player through selection of the game element, and exchange the game element with a price or in-game currency by the player (Step **9**). In this trading, the store presentation controller **62** refers to the possessed currency information of the player information database D**1**, and consumes the possessed currency in the following order. [0252] 1. The free of charge currency is consumed in ascending order of the date of acquisition. [0253] 2. After the free of charge currency units reaches zero, the paid-for currency is consumed in ascending order of the date of acquisition.

[0254] The store presentation controller **62** then updates the possessed game card information, the possessed currency information, or the purchase history information of the player information database D**1**, and transmits the updated information of the player information database D**1** to the game server **2** (Step **10**).

[0255] The player information manager **80** of the game server **2** receives the updated information of the player information database D**1**, and updates the player information on the player (Step **11**). The above operation is repeated for each selection, and purchase by the player.

[0256] Next, the operation of the player terminal **1** and the game server **2** at the time of purchase of a pack will be described. FIG. **29** is a sequence diagram for explaining the operation of the player terminal **1** and the game server **2**.

[0257] The player of the player terminal **1** selects a desired pack from the store screen, and the player terminal **1** transmits the game element ID of the selected pack (Step **21**).

[0258] After completion of the purchase procedure of the pack, the game server **2** performs a drawing lots process on the game elements to be included in the pack (Step **22**). The game server **2** then transmits the pack information on the pack (Step **23**). In the present embodiment, it is assumed that the pack consists of eight game cards, and the following game element IDs are selected by drawing lots: a game element ID “2021”, a game element ID “2056”, a game element ID “2078”, a game element ID “2088”, a game element ID “2147”, a game element ID “2159”, a game element ID “2299”, and a game element ID “2347”.

[0259] The player terminal **1** receives the pack information, and starts a pack opening direction process (Step **24**).

[0260] Next, the pack opening direction process performed at the player terminal **1** will be described. FIG. **30** is a flowchart for the pack opening direction process.

[0261] The direction presentation controller **63** receives the pack information on the pack provided from the game server **2** (Step **100**). The game element IDs of the eight game cards included in the received pack information are assumed to be the game element ID “2021”, the game element ID “2056”, the game element ID “2078”, the game element ID “2088”, the game element ID “2147”,

the game element ID “2159”, the game element ID “2299”, and the game element ID “2347”.
[0262] The direction presentation controller **63** obtains rarity information corresponding to the game element IDs from the game element information database D**2**. The pieces of rarity information corresponding to the game element IDs are as follows (Step **101**):
[0263] The rarity information for the game element ID “2021” is “1”.
[0264] The rarity information for the game element ID “2056” is “1”.
[0265] The rarity information for the game element ID “2078” is “3”.
[0266] The rarity information for the game element ID “2088” is “1”.
[0267] The rarity information for the game element ID “2147” is “5”.
[0268] The rarity information for the game element ID “2159” is “1”.
[0269] The rarity information for the game element ID “2299” is “1”.
[0270] The rarity information for the game element ID “2347” is “1”.
[0271] The direction presentation controller **63** directs and presents the game cards in the first mode and the second mode as the direction in the first stage (Step **102**). In this example, the threshold value for rarity information is assumed to be “2”.
[0272] As illustrated in FIG. **27**A, as the direction in the first stage, the direction presentation controller **63** indicates that the game card **303** has high rarity information in the first mode in which the outer edge of the back surface of the game card **303** is thickened. In contrast, other game cards excluding the game card **303** are presented in the second mode.
[0273] The direction presentation controller **63** determines selection of a game card (Step **103**). When a game card is selected (Step **104**), the rarity information of the game card is determined (Step **105**). When the rarity information of the selected game card exceeds a threshold value (Step **106**), the mode of the game card is determined (Step **107**).
[0274] When the mode of the selected game card is the first mode (Step **108**), as illustrated in FIG. **27**B, the direction presentation controller **63** performs the first direction (one flip) (Step **109**). In contrast, when the mode of the selected game card is not the first mode (Step **108**), as illustrated in FIG. **27**E, the direction presentation controller **63** performs the second direction (two flips) (Step **112**).
[0275] The direction presentation controller **63** determines whether all presented game cards have been selected (determines completion of the opening direction process) (Step **110**), and upon completion of the selection of all game cards, ends the opening direction process (Step **111**).
[0276] In the embodiment of the present invention, in addition to the game elements that are sold normally, the game elements that are provided (granted) only in a specific number or in a specific time period are supplied, thus the interest of each player to the game elements can be maintained continually.
[0277] In the embodiment of the present invention, currently untradable game elements are presented as unselectable so that the player can recognize the game elements provided in the past, and the interest of the player to the game elements can be maintained continually. In addition, the player cannot select from the unprovidable game elements presented, thus such a game element cannot be selected by mistake, and the convenience of the player is improved.
[0278] In the present embodiment, each screen is provided with means (for example, an icon, a button) for making a transition to the in-game currency providing screen, thus it is possible to make a transition from each screen to the in-game currency providing screen to obtain in-game currency as necessary, and the convenience of the player is improved.
[0279] In the present embodiment, each screen is provided with means (for example, an icon, a button) for showing the breakdown of the in-game currency, thus the player can recognize the balance of possessed in-game currency, and the breakdown between paid-for and free of charge in-game currency as necessary, and the convenience of the player is improved.
[0280] In the present embodiment, as a method for directing opening the game cards, a first direction method performed when value information does not exceed a threshold value, a second

direction method performed when value information exceeds a threshold value, and a third direction method performed on a special game card when value information exceeds a threshold value are combined to direct the opening of the game cards, thereby making it possible to provide games that are unexpected to the player and have enhanced enjoyment.

[0281] In the present embodiment, the first area for displaying the leader card included in a deck, and the second area for displaying the other game cards included in the deck are presented, and only one leader card is displayed in the first area, thus the leader card required to form a deck can be emphasized.

[0282] In the second area, multiple same game cards included in a deck are displayed in a stacked form, thus the player can easily recognize that there are multiple same game cards.

[0283] A list of the game cards forming a deck can be displayed, and a function of enlarged display to know the details of the game cards is provided, thus the convenience of the player is improved.

[0284] In addition, when a deck is registered, it is determined whether any non-conforming condition for deck is satisfied, thus a deck unusable for a fighting game is not registered as a usable deck for a fighting game by mistake.

[0285] In the present embodiment, the viewing function for the player to easily view the game cards placed in each area of the play field, and the hand of cards enlargement/reduction function, and selection function are provided, thus a highly convenient environment for playing by the player can be provided.

Modification 1 of Embodiment

[0286] The store presentation controller **62** may set an upper limit amount to be charged daily, monthly, or yearly, and when the total charge exceeds the upper limit amount in trading of a game element, which involves charging, may notify of the situation. For example, the store presentation controller **62** may calculate a monthly total charge from the purchase history information of the player information database D**1**, and when the total charge exceeds a predetermined amount, may notify of the situation in trading of game elements. FIG. **25** is a view illustrating an example of a notification made when the total charge exceeds a predetermined amount. With this configuration, excessive charging can be avoided, and particularly, people who do not have a solid financial base, such as minors can be protected.

Modification 2 of Embodiment

[0287] The store presentation controller **62** may set an upper limit to the possessable amount of in-game currency. For example, when the player purchases new in-game currency on the in-game currency providing screen, the store presentation controller **62** refers to the possessed currency information of the player information database D**1**, and when purchase of the new in-game currency causes the possessed currency units (the total of the paid-for currency units and the free of charge currency units) to exceed a predetermined amount, presents a selection button for in-game currency in a distinguishable manner from the other selection buttons. When the selection button is selected, the store presentation controller **62** notifies that the upper limit of possessable in-game currency is exceeded, and prohibits the purchase of the new in-game currency.

[0288] FIG. **26** shows views for explaining modification 2 of the embodiment. In the example of FIG. **26**, the upper limit of possessed currency is set to 1000. When the bargain product is purchased, the total of possessed in-game currency units is 1050 which exceeds the upper limit 1000, but when a normal product is purchased, the total is 1000 which does not exceed the upper limit 1000. Thus, a button **240** to select the bargain product is presented as unselectable in black, and a button **241** to select the normal product is presented as selectable in white. Thus, the player cannot select the bargain product. In addition, when the player selects the button **240**, the following message is displayed: “the possessed in-game currency has exceeded additionally purchasable currency units. Consume in-game currency to purchase new product.

[0289] With this configuration, in-game currency more than necessary does not need to be possessed, excessive charging can be avoided, and particularly, people who do not have a solid financial base, such as minors can be protected.

Modification 3 of Embodiment

[0290] Modification 3 of the present embodiment will be described. Modification **3** of the present embodiment is another example of the above-described pack opening direction. FIGS. **31**A to **31**F show views for explaining an opening direction example.

[0291] According to the pack opening direction method in modification 3 of the present embodiment, in the first stage, all game cards are presented with the same size and picture pattern (back surfaces) regardless of value information. When the value information of the selected game card does not exceed a predetermined threshold value, the first direction (one flip) is performed in which the game card is turned back to front, the front surface of game card **2** is displayed, and the character information is recognizably presented (FIG. **31**C). In contrast, when the value information of the selected game card exceeds a predetermined threshold value, the game card is displayed in an enlarged scale, and the character information is recognizably presented (FIG. **31**E). Subsequently, the game card is resumed to normal display (FIG. **31**F). By adopting such direction method, the opening direction for the pack can be performed according to the value information.

Modification 4 of Embodiment

[0292] Modification 4 of the present embodiment will be described. Modification 4 of the present embodiment is another example of the above-described pack opening direction. FIGS. **31**A to **31**F show views for explaining an opening direction example.

[0293] According to the direction method in modification 4 of the present embodiment, in the first stage, all game cards are presented with the same size and picture pattern (back surfaces) regardless of value information (FIG. **32**A). The direction method is such that each time a card is selected, only the selected game card is displayed in an enlarged scale (FIG. **31**C). The direction method in modification 4 of the present embodiment is advantageous in that character information is easily visually recognized because the game cards are displayed in an enlarged scale one by one.

[0294] Although the present invention has been described by way of a preferred embodiment above, the present invention is not necessarily limited to the aforementioned embodiment, and various modifications may be made within the scope of the technical idea.

[0295] Part or all of the aforementioned embodiment is described as in the appendix below, but is not limited thereto.

Appendix 1

[0296] A program causing a computer to function as: [0297] an execution unit configured to execute a fighting game using a game element; [0298] a play field presentation unit configured to present a play field including a plurality of areas; and [0299] a game element presentation unit configured to present character information of a game element of a player positioned in a first area among the plurality of areas so that the character information is visually unrecognizable to an opponent player, and to present character information of a game element of the player positioned in a second area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the opponent player.

Appendix 2

[0300] The program according to Appendix 1, [0301] wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to present the character information of the game element of the player positioned in at least part of the first area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the player.

Appendix 3

[0302] The program according to Appendix 1 or 2, [0303] wherein the play field presentation unit is configured not to present a boundary line between the first area and the second area in a visually recognizable manner.

Appendix 4

[0304] The program according to any one of Appendices 1 to 3, [0305] wherein the first area is greater in number than the second area.

Appendix 5

[0306] The program according to any one of Appendices 1 to 4, [0307] wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to position a game element in one of the first area or the second area according to a type of the game element.
Appendix 6
[0308] The program according to any one of Appendices 1 to 5, [0309] wherein the fighting game includes a plurality of turns, and [0310] the game element presentation unit is configured to perform control to allow the game element to be positioned in at least one of the first area or the second area in each of the turns of the player.
Appendix 7
[0311] The program according to any one of Appendices 1 to 6, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to control the game element positioned in the first area movably to the second area according to a progress of the fighting game.
Appendix 8
[0312] The program according to any one of Appendices 1 to 7, wherein the game element includes a first type game element, and a second type game element, and the game element presentation unit is configured to position the first type game element in one area in the second area, and to position the second type game element in the first area and the second area other than the one area.
Appendix 9
[0313] The program according to any one of Appendices 1 to 8, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to present the first type game element as a human-like image, and to present the second type game element as a card-like image.
Appendix 10
[0314] The program according to any one of Appendices 1 to 9, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to control the first type game element immovably from the one area in the second area to another area.
Appendix 11
[0315] A gaming device comprising: an execution unit configured to execute a fighting game using a game element; a play field presentation unit configured to present a play field including a plurality of areas; and a game element presentation unit configured to present character information of a game element of a player positioned in a first area among the plurality of areas so that the character information is visually unrecognizable to an opponent player, and to present character information of a game element of the player positioned in a second area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the opponent player.

Claims

1. A non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing a computer to function as: an execution unit configured to execute a fighting game using a game element; a play field presentation unit configured to present a play field including a plurality of areas; and a game element presentation unit configured to present character information of a game element of a player positioned in a first area among the plurality of areas so that the character information is visually unrecognizable to an opponent player, and to present character information of a game element of the player positioned in a second area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the opponent player.
2. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 1, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to present the character information of the game element of the player positioned in at least part of the first area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the player.
3. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 1, wherein the play field presentation unit is configured not to present a boundary line between the first area and the second

area in a visually recognizable manner.

4. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 3, wherein the first area is greater in number than the second area.

5. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 3, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to position a game element in one of the first area or the second area according to a type of the game element.

6. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 5, wherein the fighting game includes a plurality of turns, and the game element presentation unit is configured to perform control to allow the game element to be positioned in at least one of the first area or the second area in each of the turns of the player.

7. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 5, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to control the game element positioned in the first area movably to the second area according to a progress of the fighting game.

8. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 5, wherein the game element includes a first type game element, and a second type game element, and the game element presentation unit is configured to position the first type game element in one area in the second area, and to position the second type game element in the first area and the second area other than the one area.

9. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 8, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to present the first type game element as a human-like image, and to present the second type game element as a card-like image.

10. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 9, wherein the game element presentation unit is configured to control the first type game element immovably from the one area in the second area to another area.

11. A gaming device comprising: an execution unit configured to execute a fighting game using a game element; a play field presentation unit configured to present a play field including a plurality of areas; and a game element presentation unit configured to present character information of a game element of a player positioned in a first area among the plurality of areas so that the character information is visually unrecognizable to an opponent player, and to present character information of a game element of the player positioned in a second area so that the character information is visually recognizable to the opponent player.

12. The non-transitory computer readable medium according to claim 2, wherein the play field presentation unit is configured not to present a boundary line between the first area and the second area in a visually recognizable manner.